FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of July 19–25, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — 1 John 4:18

"There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 1 Samuel 2:18–36; Acts 15:22–41
Mon: 1 Samuel 3:1–21; Acts 16:1–22
Tue: 1 Samuel 4:1–22; Acts 16:23–40
Wed: 1 Samuel 5:1–6:3, 10–16; Acts 18:1–11, 23–28
Thu: 1 Samuel 6:19–7:17; Acts 19:1–22
Fri: 1 Samuel 8:1–22; Acts 21:15–36
Sat: 1 Samuel 9:1–27; Acts 21:37–22:16

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Come, Ye Thankful People, Come" — LSB 892

All the world is God's own field, / Fruit unto His praise to yield; / Wheat and tares together sown, / Unto joy or sorrow grown; / First the blade and then the ear, / Then the full corn shall appear. / Lord of harvest, grant that we / Wholesome grain and pure may be.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Eighth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 11) July 19, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 86:11–15; antiphon: v. 6*

Give ear, O LORD, to my prayer;
listen to my plea for grace.
Teach me your way, O LORD, that I may walk in your truth;
unite my heart to fear your name.
I give thanks to you, O Lord my God, with my whole heart,
and I will glorify your name forever.
For great is your steadfast love toward me;
you have delivered my soul from the depths of Sheol.
O God, insolent men have risen up against me; a band of ruthless men seek my life,
and they do not set you before them.
But you, O Lord, are a God merciful and gracious,
slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love and faithfulness.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Give ear, O LORD, to my prayer;
listen to my plea for grace.

Collect of the Day

O God, so rule and govern our hearts and minds by Your Holy Spirit that, ever mindful of Your final judgment, we may be stirred up to holiness of living here and dwell with You in perfect joy hereafter; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 44:6–8 · Psalm 119:57–64 · Romans 8:18–27 · Matthew 13:24–30, 36–43

Gradual *Romans 11:33, 36*

Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God!
How unsearchable are his judgments and how inscrutable his ways!
For from him and through him and to him are all things.
To him be glory forever. Amen.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 12)

Deuteronomy 7:6–9 · Psalm 125 · Romans 8:28–39 · Matthew 13:44–52

Learn by Heart: The First Article of the Creed *LSB p. 322*

"I believe that God has made me and all creatures; that He has given me my body and soul, eyes, ears, and all my members, my reason and all my senses, and still takes care of them… All this He does only out of fatherly, divine goodness and mercy…"

THIS WEEK AT HOME: In this Sunday's Gospel, an enemy sows weeds among the wheat — and the Master says, "Let both grow together until the harvest." God is patient so that people may repent; the sorting belongs to Him, not us. Through the week, watch the readings show wheat and weeds side by side: faithful little Samuel next to Eli's wicked sons, the ark of God in Dagon's temple, and Paul preaching boldly among friends and enemies alike. Ask one another: "Where do we need patience with people this week — and how has God been patient with us?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Collect"?

The word "collect" (pronounced COLL-ect) comes from the Latin word collectus, which means "gathered together." A Collect is a prayer to God which gathers together the thoughts of the congregation into one prayer for the day.

We use the Collect because it focuses the congregation's prayers and attention on the readings from God's Word that follow. This Sunday, listen for the theme in the Collect — then listen for it again in the Gospel of the wheat and the weeds.

Parents: *Before the Collect is prayed in the service, remind your children to pray in their minds along with the pastor and to listen for the same theme in the Collect and in the Gospel reading.*

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